

Ease of moving places for the Indian tourist

The Indian passport gained the most strength in the last six months, according to the latest Henley Passport Index, which **lists** countries by the number of destinations holders can travel to without needing to obtain a prior visa. **Gratifying** as the development is, India now ranks 77 - up from 85 - and has quite a way to go to make it into the top 10 list. Typically, **acquiring** a visa becomes easier with rising **per-capita income**, explaining the **strength** of passports issued by G7 countries. By this **yardstick**, India remains a middle-income country that **imposes** 'costs' on **outbound travel**. Yet, the next wave of global travel is expected to be led by Indians, and it would be in the interest of popular destinations to make themselves more welcoming to the Indian tourist. A **degree** of **reciprocity** is involved with India having to make the visa process easier for **inbound travellers**.



Indians seem to **favour** destinations in Asia because of improving connectivity, favourable exchange rates and easier visa requirements. **Efforts** to **strengthen** the Indian passport within the Asia-Pacific region **could accelerate** the nation's climb in global rankings. India has a large **untapped potential** for inbound **convention** tourism that should benefit from improving connectivity and an easy visa regime. **Saturation** of this category in mature Western markets, and the **geographical diversity** of India's offerings against Asian competitors, **should** help the country **meet** its target of doubling its share of the global MICE (meetings, incentives, conferences and exhibitions) tourism market. The expanding **footprints** of the Indian **aviation** and hospitality industries **are** **facilitators**.

Beyond its rising **economic power**, India **projects** a fairly open foreign policy that contributes to the strength of its passport. The country is also the biggest supplier of **migrant workers** across the world. It is also the biggest **recipient** of **remittances**. This **adds to** the need for India to **place** special **emphasis on facilitating** foreign travel.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- **Project** (verb) – Envisage, propose, intend, anticipate योजना बनाना

Vocabulary

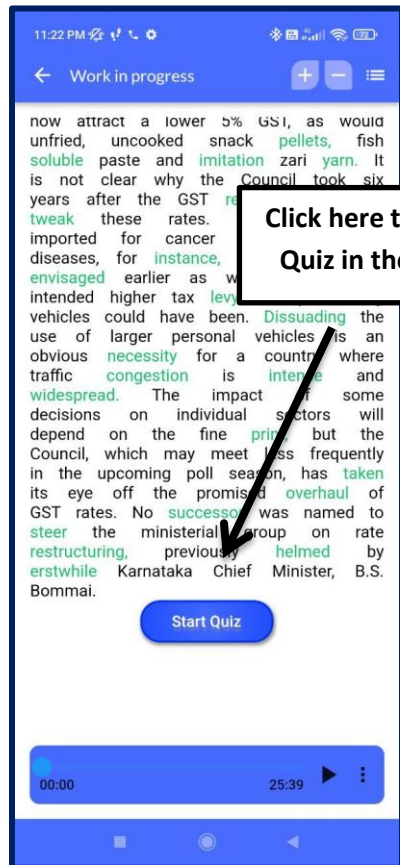
1. **List** (verb) – catalog, enumerate, register, record, detail सूचीबद्ध करना essentially visitors coming into a country from abroad आगंतुक यात्री
2. **Gratify** (verb) – please, satisfy, delight, gladden, content संतुष्ट करना
3. **Acquire** (verb) – obtain, gain, procure, receive, attain प्राप्त करना
4. **Per-capita income** (noun) – a measure of the amount of money earned per person in a nation or geographic region. प्रति व्यक्ति आय
5. **Strength** (noun) – power, force, robustness, vigor, intensity शक्ति
6. **Yardstick** (noun) – standard, benchmark, criterion, gauge, norm मापदंड
7. **Impose** (verb) – enforce, levy, dictate, inflict, implement थोपना
8. **Outbound travel** (noun) – residents of a country traveling to other countries for leisure, business, or other purposes विदेश यात्रा
9. **Degree** (noun) – level, extent, magnitude, amount, measure स्तर
10. **Reciprocity** (noun) – mutuality, exchange, interchange, give-and-take, cooperation पारस्परिकता
11. **Inbound traveller** (noun) – foreign tourists traveling to a specific country,
12. **Favour** (verb) – prefer, support, back, recommend, endorse पसंद करना
13. **Strengthen** (verb) – reinforce, boost, enhance, fortify, improve मजबूत करना
14. **Accelerate** (verb) – speed up, quicken, hasten, expedite, advance तेज करना
15. **Untapped** (adjective) – unused, undiscovered, unexplored, dormant, hidden अप्रयुक्त
16. **Potential** (noun) – capability, capacity, possibility, promise, aptitude क्षमता
17. **Convention** (noun) – assembly, meeting, conference, gathering, congress सम्मेलन
18. **Saturation** (noun) – fullness, congestion, excess, overabundance, glut अधिकता
19. **Geographical** (adjective) – spatial, regional, territorial, topographical, areal भौगोलिक
20. **Diversity** (noun) – variety, multiplicity, range, assortment, heterogeneity विविधता
21. **Meet** (verb) – fulfill, achieve, satisfy, attain, comply पूरा करना

22. **Footprint** (noun) – presence, mark, influence, impact, trace प्रभाव क्षेत्र
23. **Aviation** (noun) – air travel, aeronautics, flight, aerospace, aircraft industry विमानन
24. **Facilitator** (noun) – enabler, helper, coordinator, intermediary, supporter सुगमकर्ता
25. **Economic power** (noun) – It refers to the ability of countries, businesses or individuals to make decisions on their own that benefit them. आर्थिक शक्ति
26. **Migrant worker** (noun) – a person who moves to another country or area in order to find employment, in particular seasonal or temporary work. प्रवासी श्रमिक
27. **Recipient** (noun) – beneficiary, receiver, acceptor, awardee, heir प्राप्तकर्ता
28. **Remittance** (noun) – money transfer, payment, dispatch, remitted funds, wire विदेशी मुद्रा प्रेषण
29. **Add to** (phrasal verb) – increase, enhance, amplify, augment, contribute to बढ़ाना
30. **Place emphasis on** (phrase) – stress, highlight, underscore, prioritize, focus on जोर देना
31. **Facilitate** (verb) – assist, ease, help, simplify, enable सुगम बनाना

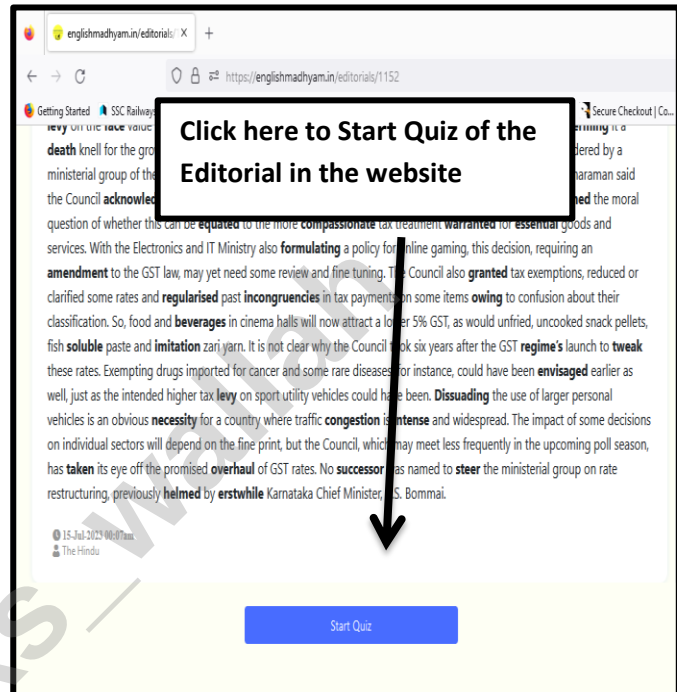
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Passport Ranking Improved:** India's passport rank improved from 85 to 77 in the latest Henley Passport Index, showing growing travel freedom.
2. **Visa-Free Access Measure:** The ranking is based on the number of destinations accessible without prior visa arrangements.
3. **Still Far From Top:** Despite improvement, India is still far from entering the top 10 passport rankings.
4. **Economic Link to Visa Ease:** Visa accessibility is generally linked to a country's per-capita income, explaining the strong passport ranks of G7 countries.
5. **India Is Middle-Income:** India's middle-income status limits ease of outbound travel and affects passport strength.
6. **Indian Tourists Rising:** The next global travel surge is expected to be led by Indian tourists, creating incentive for other countries to ease visa restrictions for them.
7. **Reciprocity Matters:** India must also make visa processes easier for inbound travellers to ensure mutual travel benefits.
8. **Asian Destinations Favoured:** Indian travellers prefer Asian countries due to better connectivity, favorable exchange rates, and lenient visa policies.
9. **Strengthening Regional Ties:** Enhancing India's passport power within the Asia-Pacific could improve global standing faster.
10. **Inbound Convention Tourism Potential:** India holds untapped potential in MICE tourism (meetings, incentives, conferences, and exhibitions).
11. **Global MICE Target:** India aims to double its global MICE market share, aided by better visa norms and infrastructure.
12. **Edge Over Western Markets:** India can benefit as Western convention tourism markets saturate, while offering more geographical diversity.
13. **Aviation and Hospitality Role:** Growth in Indian aviation and hospitality sectors supports both outbound and inbound tourism.
14. **Foreign Policy Impact:** India's open and stable foreign policy contributes positively to its global travel reputation.
15. **Migrant Workforce & Remittances:** As the largest exporter of migrant workers and top remittance recipient, India must prioritize easier foreign travel access for its citizens.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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